STARTER KIT • VERSION 1.0

Notion Freelancer Starter Kit

Run your clients, projects and invoices from one calm workspace. Five databases, ready-to-paste templates and a Friday review.

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What is inside

Read it in one sitting, then build one chapter a day. You will be running your work from Notion by the end of the week.

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Who this is for

Freelancers who sell their time or their work: designers, developers, writers, consultants, editors. If you have more than two clients and an inbox you do not trust, this kit is for you.

CHAPTER 1

Set up in twenty minutes

One page, five databases, three rules. Nothing else.

Create a page called **Studio**. Inside it, create five full-page databases: **Clients**, **Projects**, **Invoices**, **Tasks** and **Notes**. Connect them with relations so that a task knows its project, a project knows its client and an invoice knows both.

Database	Kind	Holds
Clients	Database	Everyone you work for, and every lead you are chasing
Projects	Database	One row per piece of paid work, related to a client
Invoices	Database	One row per invoice, related to a client and a project
Tasks	Database	Small steps, related to a project
Notes	Database	Meetings, calls and ideas, related to a client

The three rules

- **One home for everything.** If it is not in Studio, it does not exist.
- **Relations over copies.** Never type a client name twice; relate to the client row.
- **Every row has a next step.** A row without a next step is clutter.

> **Tip**
> Give every database a short icon and colour. You will recognise them faster than words, and your sidebar will stay readable.

CHAPTER 2

Clients

The place you open first every morning.

Property	Type	What it is for
Name	Title	Person or company
Status	Select	Lead, Active, Paused, Past
Email	Email	Where invoices go
Next follow-up	Date	The next time you must write to them
Projects	Relation	Links to the Projects database
Total billed	Rollup	Sum of Amount from related Invoices
Notes	Text	How they like to work

Views to add

- **Board by Status** to see your pipeline at a glance.
- **Table: Follow up this week**, filtered to Next follow-up is within the next 7 days.
- **Gallery** with a cover image per client for a friendlier view.

A client page template

```
Client: [name]        Status: Active
Contact: [person], [email], best time to reach
How they like updates: [email / call / shared doc]
Payment terms: [14 days]   Currency: [USD]
Next follow-up: [date]

Projects  (linked view)
Invoices  (linked view)
Notes     (linked view)
```

Why it works
The follow-up date turns your client list from a phone book into a to-do list. Once a week you filter for this week, write the messages and move the dates.

CHAPTER 3

Projects

Scope, stage, fee and due date, always in view.

Property	Type	What it is for
Project	Title	Short, specific name
Client	Relation	Links to Clients
Stage	Select	Brief, Draft, Review, Revisions, Done
Due	Date	The date you promised
Fee	Number	Agreed price
Invoiced	Rollup	Sum of Amount from related Invoices
Left to bill	Formula	Fee minus Invoiced

Views to add

- **Board by Stage** is your production line.
- **Calendar on Due** shows crunch weeks before they arrive.
- **Table: Not done**, sorted by Due, filtered to Stage is not Done.

The project brief

Paste this at the top of every new project page and fill it in before you start. Ten minutes here saves ten hours later.

```
Goal: what must be true when this is finished?
Deliverables: list each file, page or feature
Not included: what we agreed not to do
Dates: kick-off / first draft / final
Feedback: who gives it, how many rounds
Fee and payment: amount, deposit, due date
```

CHAPTER 4

Invoices

Be paid on time without being awkward about it.

Property	Type	What it is for
Invoice no.	Title	2026-001, 2026-002, and so on
Client	Relation	Links to Clients
Project	Relation	Links to Projects
Amount	Number	Total including tax
Sent on	Date	The day you sent it
Paid on	Date	Leave empty until the money arrives
Status	Formula	Draft, Sent, Overdue or Paid, worked out for you

The status formula

Create a formula property called Status. It reads the dates and decides, so you never update it by hand.

```
if(prop("Paid on") != empty(), "Paid",
  if(prop("Sent on") == empty(), "Draft",
    if(dateBetween(now(), prop("Sent on"), "days") > 14, "Overdue", "Sent")))
```

Add a table view filtered to **Status is Overdue** and pin it to your sidebar. That view is your collections list. On a quiet Friday, work through it from the oldest down.

> **Payment terms that get paid**
> State the due date on the invoice itself, in plain words: "Due on 14 March." Offer one easy way to pay, and send a reminder the day after the due date, not three weeks later.

CHAPTER 5

Tasks

Small steps that move a project forward.

Property	Type	What it is for
Task	Title	Start with a verb: Send, Draft, Call
Project	Relation	Links to Projects
When	Select	Today, This week, Later, Waiting
Due	Date	Only when it is a real deadline
Done	Checkbox	Tick to archive from your daily view

Your daily view

Create a table named **Today**, filtered to When is Today and Done is unchecked. Open it each morning. If it has more than five rows, you are planning a fantasy, not a day.

The Waiting column

Anything that depends on a client goes under **Waiting**, with the date you asked. On Friday you read that list and nudge. It is the single best habit in this kit for keeping projects moving.

> **Rule of three**
> Pick at most three tasks that would make today a success. Everything else is a bonus.

CHAPTER 6

The Friday review

Fifteen minutes. Every week. It is what makes the rest work.

Set a recurring reminder for Friday at 4 pm. Make a template button in Studio named **Weekly review** that creates a new note with the list below, then tick the boxes.

- [ ] Clear the **Review** stage: send the work or move it back to Draft.
- [ ] Open **Follow up this week** and write every message, then move each date forward.
- [ ] Open **Overdue** invoices and send a polite reminder to each client.
- [ ] Mark everything that was paid this week with its Paid on date.
- [ ] Empty the **Waiting** list: nudge anyone who has had it for more than three days.
- [ ] Choose the three tasks for Monday and set When to Today.
- [ ] Write three lines: what went well, what was hard, what to change.

The monthly check

- [ ] Total billed this month and total still unpaid.
- [ ] Which client took more time than their fee deserved?
- [ ] Archive finished projects, past clients and old notes.
- [ ] Raise your price for the next new client by ten percent.

CHAPTER 7

Copy-paste templates

Four messages you will send again and again. Change the brackets and send.

Proposal

```
Hi [name],

Thanks for the call. Here is what I understood: [goal in one sentence].
I suggest [deliverables], finished by [date], for [fee].
That includes [rounds] rounds of feedback. [Anything else] is quoted separately.
If that works, reply "go" and I will send the invoice for the deposit.

[Your name]
```

Project kick-off

```
Hi [name],

We start on [date]. To begin I need: [files, access, decisions].
You will see a first draft on [date]. Please send feedback within [3] days.
The best way to reach me is [channel]. I reply within one working day.

[Your name]
```

Invoice reminder

```
Hi [name],

A quick note: invoice [number] for [amount] was due on [date].
Here is the link to pay: [link]. If it has crossed in the post, ignore this.

Thank you, [Your name]
```

Project wrap-up

```
Hi [name],

That is everything delivered: [list]. I will keep the files for [6 months].
If you are happy, a two-line testimonial would mean a lot. And if you have
another project in mind, I have room from [date].

[Your name]
```

CHAPTER 8

Formula cheat sheet

Nine formulas, each one line. Paste them into formula properties.

Formula	Paste this
Days since sent	`dateBetween(now(), prop("Sent on"), "days")`
Is overdue	`prop("Status") == "Overdue"`
Left to bill	`prop("Fee") - prop("Invoiced")`
Days until due	`dateBetween(prop("Due"), now(), "days")`
Due soon flag	`if(dateBetween(prop("Due"), now(), "days") < 4, "Soon", "")`
Late fee (5 percent)	`if(prop("Status") == "Overdue", prop("Amount") * 0.05, 0)`
Client label	`prop("Name") + " (" + prop("Status") + ")"`
Paid percentage	`round(prop("Invoiced") / prop("Fee") * 100)`
This month	`formatDate(prop("Sent on"), "MMM YYYY") == formatDate(now(), "MMM YYYY")`

If a formula shows an error
Check that the property names match yours exactly, including capital letters. Notion formulas treat "Sent on" and "sent on" as different names.

CHAPTER 9

Questions and mistakes

The things people get stuck on, and the quick fix for each.

Do I need a paid Notion plan?

No. Everything here works on the free plan. Pay only when you need to share a workspace with a team.

I have forty clients. Is that too many rows?

No. Notion handles thousands of rows. Archive past clients to a view called Past so the main list stays short.

Should I track my time?

Only if you bill by the hour. Add a Hours number property to Tasks and a Rollup on Projects. Otherwise skip it; fixed fees are easier to manage.

My relations are a mess.

Open one database, find rows with an empty relation, and fix them with a filtered view named Missing client. It takes five minutes.

How do I share with a client?

Share one project page, not the workspace. Duplicate your project template so they only see what is theirs.

What if I fall off the habit?

Do the Friday review once, badly. A messy review still beats none. Restart with the smallest list: overdue invoices and the Waiting column.

> **The short version**
> Five databases. Relations, not copies. A next step on every row. A Friday review. That is the entire system.

Thank you for buying the Notion Freelancer Starter Kit. Questions about your order go to the shop's assistant on your confirmation page.